

08/29/26

Free Talk

Scuba diving certification 潜水证

Diving certification 潜水证

Nepal 尼泊尔

Glacier 冰川

Avalanche 雪崩

7 mins 20km

Mental math 口算

Debris-laden flood 山洪泥石流

Death toll 死亡人数 (not sure)

Border guard 边防人员

Remember the tense when you describe that

Plate boundary 板块边界

Volcanic eruption 火山爆发

Well-educated 受教育程度高的

promising /'prɒmɪsɪŋ/ ★★☆☆☆ | CET4 TEM4

ADJ Someone or something that is **promising** seems likely to be very good or successful. 有望成功的; 前景很好的

- A school has honoured one of its brightest and most promising former students.
一所学校给其培养过的最聪明、最有前途的学生中的一位颁了奖。

Homework Analysis - Question 1 (f) Summary

Read Text B, Life at Concordia Station, in the insert and then answer Question 1(f) on this question paper.

- (f) According to Text B, in what ways can living and working in Concordia Station help a person to understand what it might be like to go on a long-term mission to Mars?

You must **use continuous writing** (not note form) and **use your own words** as far as possible.

Your summary should not be more than 120 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.

Living at Concordia can show what a long-term Mars mission might be like in several ways. The huge, empty Antarctic landscape is similar to the barren environment expected on Mars, and travelling there by large vehicles gives an idea of future journeys across the planet. The lack of wildlife also reflects the possibility of finding little or no intelligent life on Mars. Concordia workers experience extreme conditions and long periods of darkness, helping them prepare for difficult environments. They also have limited contact with people outside the station, so they learn to cope with loneliness and protect their privacy while working closely with colleagues. Limited access to ordinary products and unreliable communication also prepare them for life far from Earth.

点评

Word count: 120不多不少

Content: 7/10

Forrest原文	得分点
1. Living at Concordia can show what a long-term Mars mission might be like in several ways.	【不算分】
作为文章开头是可以的，但是还是想提醒Forrest，summary只有120词，需要开头句子，但得简短	
The huge, empty Antarctic landscape is similar to the barren environment expected on Mars, and travelling there by large vehicles gives an idea of future journeys across the planet.	3 go out on missions / travel around in huge tractor / same vehicles are needed to travel around 4 the entire landscape is barren / huge desolate terrain / nothing interesting to look at anywhere / vast empty spaces
这一句很好，一句话涵盖了两个得分点。 “huge, empty Antarctic landscape / barren environment” → vast, barren, empty landscape; “travelling there by large vehicles” → using huge vehicles/tractors similar to those needed on Mars 表扬！灵活运用compound sentence ~	
The lack of wildlife also reflects the possibility of finding little or no intelligent life on Mars.	5 few life-forms / few living creatures
Forrest能踩中得分点的核心意思。不过wildlife稍微比原文的life forms窄一点，而intelligent life和原文sentient life不完全一样 虽然不会影响拿分，但是Forrest可以写得更准确一点 ~ 比如very little life may exist on Mars	
Concordia workers experience extreme conditions and long periods of darkness, helping them prepare for difficult environments.	8 having to work in extreme conditions
“experience extreme conditions” → having to work in extreme conditions 但后面的long periods of darkness虽然是原文里的，但是不是Mars和Concordia的相似点，因为原文明确说 “Mars still has day and night”。所以“darkness”并不会帮Forrest拿分哎，反而占用了字数 :(	

They also have limited contact with people outside the station, so they learn to cope with loneliness and protect their privacy while working

- 9 stress of being stuck with the same people / managing lack of privacy / working in close proximity with others / have to work out how to co-exist with colleagues
- 10 little contact with family / not seeing friends / cannot rely on video calling to home

closely with colleagues.

这句又涵盖了两个主要得分点！不错

“limited contact with people outside the station” → little contact with family/friends

“protect their privacy while working closely with colleagues” → managing privacy / living and working closely with the same people

不过，这里稍微有“加戏”成分了哦！“cope with loneliness”是Forrest自己做的推断，原文只是说这种情况stressful，没有明确写“他们学会应对孤独”。虽然问题不大，但是summary最好尽量忠实原文！

Limited access to ordinary products and unreliable communication also prepare them for life far from Earth.

- 11 missing familiar 'comforts' / missing favourite food / cannot get favourite brands

“Limited access to ordinary products” → missing familiar comforts / favourite brands / food

总结：

Forrest写到的得分点（7个）：

Point 3: large vehicles / future transport on Mars

Point 4: barren, empty landscape

Point 5: few life forms

Point 8: work in extreme conditions

Point 9: privacy + working closely with colleagues

Point 10: limited contact / unreliable communication

Point 11: lack of familiar products / comforts

没涵盖的点：

2 extremely low temperatures / Antarctica is very cold

原文说Mars比地球任何地方都冷，而Concordia至少让人体验一下这种极寒环境。虽然Forrest写了“extreme conditions”，但是“极端环境”不等于“低温”，也可以是极度干燥，极度潮湿等等。所以，Forrest一定要精准一点。

6 nothing to engage your mind / (both equally) boring

这个点的意思是环境非常单调、缺乏刺激、容易无聊。

虽然Forrest写了“huge, empty landscape”，但是这个点主要对应Point 4“荒凉空旷”。

Forrest没有进一步解释“这种环境在心理上很单调、没有什么可以吸引注意力”。

7 need to acclimatise / having to adapt to an alien environment / having to consider both places 'home'

Forrest完全没写到这一点

The quality of your writing: 4/5

1. Own words: 做得很好

2. Concision: 全文刚好控制在120词以内，而且基本没有大段重复

3. Coherence: 不是机械地列点写

4. Grammar and vocabulary: 语法几乎没有明显错误，句型也有变化

5. Style: 总体符合summary要求在陈述客观事实

-1: 有少量不够精准、略重复或不够高效的地方

Homework Analysis - Question 2 (c) Inference

- (c) Use **one example** from the text below to explain how the writer suggests what Bob experiences as he searches for water.

Use your own words in your explanation.

The ground was promisingly soft here. His booted foot sank the shovel blade through a surface layer of fine crimson crumbs. An unmistakably damp wedge of soil was removed, and clear liquid slipped gently into its place.

The writer uses the phrase "clear liquid slipped gently into its place" to suggest that Bob discovers water slowly seeping into the hole he has dug, showing that he is getting close to finding a source of water.

批改: 3/3

Forrest原文	得分点
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例子: clear liquid slipped gently into its place

Forrest选的例子很合适，对应mark scheme中的clear liquid slipped gently into its place.

Forrest用 "slowly seeping into the hole" 把 "slipped gently" 用own words说出来了，说明水不是很猛地喷出来，而是自然、平缓地进入那个空隙。

【建议】

可以更精准的地方:

"gently" 更核心的是 "轻柔、自然、没有外力"，不一定必须强调 "slowly"

Mark scheme:

- **clear liquid slipped gently into its place**: cleanliness (of the water); moves easily and readily into the space the soil had occupied; natural, understated action; without force

Question 2 (d) Language Analysis

(d) Reread paragraphs 12 and 16.

- Paragraph 12 begins 'Seconds passed ...' and is about the astronauts watching as Bob puts the sample under the microscope.
- Paragraph 16 begins 'Bob realised ...' and is about the astronauts' reactions to their discovery.

Explain how the writer uses language to convey meaning and to create effect in these paragraphs. Choose three examples of words or phrases from each paragraph to support your answer. Your choices should include the use of imagery.

Write about 200 to 300 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer.

In paragraph 12, the writer creates a sense of tension and excitement as the astronauts wait for Bob's results. The phrase "Seconds passed like hours" is a simile showing that the waiting feels extremely long because everyone is nervous and eager to discover the result. The phrase "hung over Bob's shoulder" suggests that Rajah and Sarah are intensely focused on the microscope and cannot wait to see what Bob discovers. The imagery in "Silence entered the cramped space ... and floated inquisitively" personifies silence as if it is moving around them, creating an intense and mysterious atmosphere. "Cramped" also emphasises how closely the three astronauts are gathered together.

In paragraph 16, the writer conveys the astronauts' overwhelming excitement and pride after discovering life on Mars. Bob describes the moment as "rapturous", suggesting that he experiences extreme happiness after years of preparation. The phrase "poor rehearsal" is a metaphor which suggests that all his previous training feels insignificant compared with the importance of this real discovery. Meanwhile, Sarah's "frenzy of 'selfie' live-streaming" creates imagery of wild, uncontrolled excitement. The word "frenzy" suggests that she is so excited that she immediately wants to share the discovery with everyone. Rajah's description of his achievement as "grandeur" also shows his exaggerated sense of pride and importance.

批改:

Paragraph 12

Forrest原文	得分点
In paragraph 12, the writer creates a sense of tension and excitement as the astronauts wait for Bob's results.	
这里属于overview，不是核心语言分析 不过，这句话能够先告诉读者，让他们知道这一段整体在营造什么氛围。所以，还是有用的，因为后面的例子都可以围绕这个中心展开。	
The phrase "Seconds passed like hours" is a simile showing that the waiting feels extremely long because everyone is nervous and eager to discover the result.	*time went by slowly *anticipation *eager to know the result
Forrest没有只是写 "This is simile"，而是解释了“几秒钟为什么感觉像几小时一样漫长”，说明人物非常紧张、急切地等待结果。这个分析是经符合mark scheme的。	
The phrase "hung over Bob's shoulder" suggests that Rajah and Sarah are intensely focused on the microscope and cannot wait to see what Bob discovers.	*watching closely / trying to see the result *immediately invading Bob's space
"intensely focused" 和 "cannot wait" 都抓到了人物的急切和专注。不过，Forrest还可以继续深挖 "hung over Bob's shoulder" 这个动作。这句话说明它让读者看到两个人靠得非常近，几乎挤进Bob的私人空间。Forrest没写的到评分标准的 "invading Bob's space"。	

The imagery in "Silence entered the cramped space ... and floated inquisitively" personifies silence as if it is moving around them, creating an intense and mysterious atmosphere.

*personification

前半句写得很好 ~ Forrest认出了personification, 也知道silence被写成像一个能“进入”和“飘动”的东西。不过后面的mysterious atmosphere有点泛。得分点更强调anticipation / curiosity / tension。

“inquisitively”本身就是“好奇地”的意思, 所以这里最值得写的是: 仿佛连沉默本身都在等待、好奇结果是什么。这个会比mysterious更精准, 也更体现connotation (内涵意义)。

"Cramped" also emphasises how closely the three astronauts are gathered together.

这句话只是目前停在**比较表面的空间描写上**, 可以继续往效果分析。

“cramped”不只是说明三个人靠得近, 也让rover显得狭小、封闭, 甚至有一点压迫感, 从而进一步加强等待结果时的紧张气氛。

Paragraph 16

Forrest原文

得分点

In paragraph 16, the writer conveys the astronauts' overwhelming excitement and pride after discovering life on Mars.

这句有结构作用, 但是Forrest把三个人的反应说得太统一了。Mark scheme对这一段的overview是contrasting behaviour of the three astronauts:

Bob是安静、震撼、沉思

Sarah是疯狂自拍直播

Rajah是夸张地强调自己的成就

所以这里最应该写的是**对比**, 而不只是大家都“excited and proud”。

Bob describes the moment as "rapturous", suggesting that he experiences extreme happiness after years of preparation.

extremely joyful point in time

Forrest踩得很准 ~

“rapturous” → extreme happiness

另外, Forrest联系到“多年准备”也是合理的。但是有个小问题, 严格来说不是Bob “describes” 这个moment, **而是narrator在描述**, 所以可以改成The word “rapturous” describes...更好, 避免说是谁去描述。其实, Forrest可以分析得更加深入。比如, 这个词能表现出一种几乎压倒性的喜悦, 而不只是普通开心。

The phrase "poor rehearsal" is a metaphor which suggests that all his previous training feels insignificant compared with the importance of this real discovery.

metaphor

这一句整体不错, 不过“insignificant”不够准确, 因为作者不是说之前训练不重要, 而是说即使训练了很多年, 也仍然不足以真正为这个现实瞬间做好准备。

建议使用: inadequate preparation (更贴切)

Meanwhile, Sarah's "frenzy of 'selfie' live-streaming" creates imagery of wild, uncontrolled excitement.

uncontrolled excitement / manic behaviour

这句踩得很好。“wild, uncontrolled excitement”基本直接对应了评分标准!

frenzy = 疯狂、失控的一阵行为, 所以Forrest写到Sarah非常激动, 行为很夸张, 是很贴切的 ~

不过, Forrest的quote里面, 其实还有一个很值得分析的词: selfie

Forrest有没有想过, 为什么作者不只是写“live-streaming”, 而是特意写“selfie live-streaming”呢?

因为selfie本身会让我们想到: 镜头里重点是“她自己”。Sarah不只是想“把火星生命这个发现分享出去”, 她其实也很在意让大家看到她自己出现在这个重大事件里。

所以用“selfie live-streaming”可以显得Sarah: attention-seeking (想获得关注) + self-promoting (借这个机会突出、宣传自己)

The word “frenzy” suggests that she is so excited that she immediately wants to share the discovery

with everyone.

这句最大的问题是 “share the discovery with everyone” 听起来更像纯粹热情分享，但原文实际上带明显讽刺意味

Sarah更像是在把自己放到discovery的中心来公开展示自己。所以这一句话会弱化作者的irony。

建议改成:

The word “frenzy” suggests that Sarah reacts in a frantic and uncontrolled way, while the “selfie” live-streaming makes her seem attention-seeking, as she turns the discovery into *a public performance*.

Rajah’s description of his achievement as “grandeur” also shows his exaggerated sense of pride and importance.

self-important / pompous / exaggerating his role

“his exaggerated sense of pride and importance” → self-important / pompous / exaggerating his role
很好

New Reading Task - Text C - Question 2 (c-d) Vocabulary

Read **Text C**, and then answer **Questions 2(a)–(d)** and **Question 3** on the question paper.

Text C: *Our big red bus ride*

This text is about a journey that started in 1971 and went around the North American continent.

Gradually, out of the shimmering heat, a vehicle appeared – a big, red intrusion into the barren landscape. As it approached, a ^{interested → curious} ~~curious~~ ^{person watching → spectator} ~~spectator~~ would see a bus, a double-decker, bigger and noisier than the single-deckers they sometimes saw in that part of the world. It threw up clouds of dirt and dust as it passed. It shouldn't have been there, thousands of kilometres from England. (a) (i)

^{tiny problem → very serious language → strong reaction} This is the story of that big, red double-decker bus. This isn't a children's story, and if you try reading it to children, they'll soon lose interest in the increasingly ^{trivial, unimportant, not worth taking so seriously} ~~petty~~ details of our daily life. In one early letter to my parents, I wrote: 'We had yet another meeting yesterday to sort out grievances.' This latest ^{serious/formal language for a very small problem} ~~inquest~~ had been into who'd drunk someone's orange juice from the fridge. The devastated owner knew some had been ^{overly serious word for a trivial incident} ~~stolen~~ because he'd marked the level of the liquid in the bottle. ^{这里只有橙汁少了一点 却写得很夸张} (a) (ii)

I did try to write a children's story one morning but was interrupted by shouts and a collision with something overhead. Group leader Roger had decided on buying a 'high-decker' (taller than average) and initially we left a trail of damaged overhead bridges, power cables and telephone lines wherever we went. This bus, our bus, had already covered many kilometres of faithful service before Roger purchased it second-hand. We'd each answered Roger's advert to travel around the world on this bouncing beast. We all had regular professions back home – a chef, a nurse and so on – and had come together to share an experience. We'd taken delivery of a 1955 green double-decker and decided to paint it red, the typical image of English buses. The bus company ^{still → remained really helpful → very supportive} ~~remained~~ very supportive, including sending spares out whenever we encountered a mechanical crisis. 20

It's difficult to envisage how cut off from our previous lives we were back then. Mobile phones and emails weren't yet invented. There was no internet linking different countries and cultures. To phone home was expensive and public phones weren't easy to find. I was away two years and managed to phone home twice. (b)

^{bus = their entire living world, not just transport} Our world was inside that double-decker bus – an overloaded display case of rattling glass and metal on wheels. ^{contrast} People stared in; we gazed out. The interior of the bus had been completely gutted, its normal entrance and exit doors sealed up. We gained access squeezing through the emergency door at the rear. Roger's new friend, Vic, was a skilled carpenter, magicking snug bunk beds and ingenious storage seats downstairs around an almost adequate kitchen area/table. The seats were removable – disappearing to reveal various emergency supplies, spares and snacks nestled secretly beneath. No sliver of space escaped! 25 30

That bus traversed deserts and climbed mountains – setting an altitude record of 4000 metres for such a vehicle. Rumbling across continents, only lack of money for diesel threatened to halt its determined march. Beforehand, we'd hoped to sell advertising space on the side of the bus, but that didn't happen. Our targets each day were to make enough money from manual work – mostly fruit picking – to cover growing expenses, and to overcome any lumps, bumps and obstacles that lay ahead. A double-decker bus is a heavy, awkward vehicle. On uneven or wet ground, it's less manoeuvrable than a whale in quicksand, but ever heard the expression 'You could get a double-decker bus through there?' Well, events proved that we could (until that ^{last day → end of the journey} ~~fateful~~ last day when it sank on a raft crossing a river – don't ask!). (a) (iii)

^{fateful → disastrous (having very serious / unfortunate consequences)} ~~fateful~~ ^{明明是 dramatic 的事故} We needed luck and to work together. Most of all we needed the bus to overcome conditions that it had never experienced in years of commercial service. The six of us who lasted the whole trip were two years older when we returned. Looking back, we ^{showed → displayed incredible → breath-taking} ~~displayed~~ breath-taking ^{immaturity → naivety} ~~naivety~~ in assuming that we'd not be left stranded somewhere with no money and no hope of getting home. (a) (iv)

Read Text C, *Our big red bus ride*, in the insert and then answer Questions 2(a)–(d) on this question paper.

Question 2

(a) Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined:

- (i) Any interested person watching might notice that this large bus was different from the buses they sometimes saw in their country.

curious spectator [1]

- (ii) The bus company was still really helpful after the bus had been sold.

⚠ 题目不一定只替换一个单词，有时候会把整个意思拆开

remained very supportive [1]

- (iii) The disastrous end to their journey was when the bus ended up in a river.

fateful last day [1]

- (iv) The writer and their fellow travellers showed incredible immaturity to think that they could make such a journey without mishap.

displayed breath-taking naivety [1]

(b) Using your own words, explain what the writer means by each of the words underlined:

It's difficult to envisage how cut off from our previous lives we were back then. Mobile phones and emails weren't yet invented. There was no internet linking different countries and cultures. To phone home was expensive and public phones weren't easy to find. I was away two years and managed to phone home twice.

- (i) envisage image [1]

- (ii) linking connecting [1]

- (iii) expensive cost a lot of money [1]

Homework 1 - Text B - Question 1 (f) Summary

Read **Text B**, *Clever uses for old buses*, in the insert and answer **Question 1(f)** on this question paper.

- (f) According to Text B, how **and** why are old buses being used?

You must **use continuous writing** (not note form) and **use your own words** as far as possible.

Your summary should not be more than 120 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.

Homework 2 - Text C - Question 2 (c-d)

Original article: See page 8

- (c) Use **one** example from the text below to explain how the writer suggests the attitude of the owner of the orange juice.

Use your own words in your explanation.

This is the story of that big, red double-decker bus. This isn't a children's story, and if you try reading it to children, they'll soon lose interest in the increasingly petty details of our daily life. In one early letter to my parents, I wrote: 'We had yet another meeting yesterday to sort out grievances.' This latest inquest had been into who'd drunk someone's orange juice from the fridge. The devastated owner knew some had been 'stolen' because he'd marked the level of the liquid in the bottle.

- (d) Reread paragraphs 5 and 6.

- Paragraph 5 begins 'Our world ...' and describes the inside of the bus.
- Paragraph 6 begins 'That bus ...' and describes where, when and how the bus travelled.

Explain how the writer uses language to convey meaning and to create effect in these paragraphs. Choose **three** examples of words or phrases from **each** paragraph to support your answer. Your choices should include the use of imagery.

Write about 200 to 300 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer.